FOR PARENTS · SUPPORTING YOUR YOUNG PLAYER

SIDELINE BEHAVIOUR

The best seat in the house comes with responsibility

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THE QUICK VERSION

> Your child can hear you from the sideline, even when it seems like they can't. The way parents behave on game day shapes how kids feel, how they play and whether they want to come back next week. The best sideline parents are calm, positive and loud only for the good stuff.

WHAT'S REALLY GOING ON

When players hear instructions from the sideline that clash with their coach's, they freeze. When they hear parents yelling at referees, they learn that blaming others is normal. Many junior referees are teenagers themselves, and abuse is one of the biggest reasons they quit. A positive sideline helps every child on the pitch, on both teams.

SIDELINE DO'S AND DON'TS

GREAT SIDELINE PARENT

- ✓ Cheers effort and good play
- ✓ Claps good play from both teams
- ✓ Stays calm when decisions go against them
- ✓ Leaves coaching to the coach
- ✓ Thanks the referee after the game

UNHELPFUL SIDELINE PARENT

- × Shouts instructions or tactics
- × Criticises players, even their own child
- × Yells at referees or linesmen
- × Argues with other parents
- × Paces the sideline or walks onto the pitch

What if another parent crosses the line?

Stay calm and don't engage in the moment. If it's serious or keeps happening, speak to the team manager or club after the game. Most clubs have a code of conduct for exactly this reason.

TRY THIS

1. **Cheer, don't coach**
   Stick to encouragement: "Great effort!" "Keep going!" "Well done!"

2. **Stand back from the line**
   A few steps back from the pitch keeps the space for players and coaches.

3. **Praise the referee**
   They're learning too. A thank you after the game goes a long way.

4. **Ask your child what they like**
   Some kids love loud cheering, others prefer quiet support. Ask them.

5. **Be a role model**
   Your child is watching how you handle frustration. Show them how it's done.

SAY THIS, NOT THAT

SAY THIS	NOT THAT
"Great effort, keep going!"	~~"Shoot! Pass! Go!"~~
"Unlucky, next one!"	~~"What was that?!"~~
"Thanks, ref."	~~"Ref, you're useless!"~~

QUICK SELF-CHECK

- [ ] My sideline comments are only encouragement
- [ ] I've never shouted at a referee
- [ ] I've asked my child how they like me to cheer
- [ ] I know my club's code of conduct

Can't tick them all yet? That's normal. Pick one to work on this week.

COACH'S CORNER

"Players remember the voices on the sideline. Make sure your child remembers yours as the calm, proud one.

THE FUTURE BALLER TEAM